

Operator Discovery Report: transfer_candidate_pruner_sticky_size

- Operator type: candidate_pruner.
- Host scaffold: nearest_neighbor_2opt.
- Core idea: Deterministically limit local candidate moves using a compact base list, increasing focus when instances look grid-like or clustered, and backing off when stagnation suggests traps.
- Novelty classification: descriptor_adaptive_pruner.
- Rediscovery signature: candidate_pruner:18:-4:3:2.
- Surviving candidate: False.
- Problem class where it helps: none confirmed.

Pseudocode

- Start from a base candidate-list size.
- Expand or shrink the list using instance descriptors such as size, trap score, grid-likeness, clustering, and current stagnation.
- Run the downstream local search only on the resulting pruned neighborhood.

Complexity

- Non-empty lines: 12.
- Complexity score: 0.44.
- Fingerprint: 4ba619c8530de1f4.

Why It Should Help

- The operator adapts neighborhood size to instance structure, which can trade off search breadth and runtime in a reusable way.

Failure Cases

- Does not transplant cleanly into clustered_local_search.
- No validation family shows a clear improvement over the host baseline.
- Disabling the operator does not hurt, so the ablation does not support a real operator effect.
- Runtime inflation is high at 0.316569.

Transplant Results

- nearest_neighbor_2opt gap delta 0.000609, runtime delta 65.175371, distance-eval delta 2186.714286.
- cheapest_insertion_2opt gap delta 0.0, runtime delta 252.454943, distance-eval delta 1111.428571.
- random_restart_2opt gap delta 0.001067, runtime delta 2.242143, distance-eval delta 1844.428571.
- sparse_three_opt gap delta -0.000253, runtime delta 53.7399, distance-eval delta 4353.428571.
- clustered_local_search gap delta 0.015514, runtime delta 150.475243, distance-eval delta 6061.142857.

Instance-Family Results

- heldout_tsplib operator gap 0.235667 vs baseline 0.235058.
- clustered_tsp operator gap 0.110853 vs baseline 0.110853.
- elongated_corridor_tsp operator gap 0.003204 vs baseline 0.003204.
- grid_like_tsp operator gap 0.106696 vs baseline 0.106696.
- nearest_neighbor_trap_tsp operator gap 0.0 vs baseline 0.0.
- two_cluster_bottleneck_tsp operator gap 0.109057 vs baseline 0.109057.
- uniform_euclidean operator gap 0.0 vs baseline 0.0.

Pareto Results

- Gap delta: 0.000224.
- Runtime inflation: 0.316569.
- Distance-evaluation inflation: 0.22697.
- Same-gap-faster flag: False.
- Better-gap-same-runtime flag: False.

Ablation Results

- disabled mean gap 0.121317 and delta vs full operator -0.000224.
- constant_pruner mean gap 0.121542 and delta vs full operator 0.0.
- wide_pruner mean gap 0.121542 and delta vs full operator 0.0.